

Anal fissures

vs

Haemorrhoids

Small tears in the skin that lines the anus.	Definitions	Swollen veins that occur in and around the anus.
Usually caused by injury to the area. This can happen when passing a large or hard stool.	Causes	Usually caused by constipation and straining to pass stools.
• Pain during and after going to the toilet • Cramping around the anus • Blood on toilet paper or stool • Itchiness around the anus	Symptoms	• Bright red blood on the toilet paper or in the toilet • Itchiness, discomfort, or pain around the anus • Lump that protrudes out of the anus
• Muscle relaxant cream (such as 0.2% glyceryl trinitrate) • Pain-relieving medication • Botox injections • Some may require surgery (sphincterotomy)	Treatment	• Over-the-counter haemorrhoid treatments • Injection (sclerotherapy) • Rubber band ligation • Some may require surgery (haemorrhoidectomy)